PROJECT TITLE: CSE0001- DIGITAL LITERACY

REPORT ON DIGITAL LITERACY AND PROFESSIONAL ONLINE PRESENCE

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TABLE OF CONTENT

1. Executive Summary

2. Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

3. Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

4. Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

5. Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

6. Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

7. Conclusion and Future Recommendations

8. Reference Links

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report outlines a comprehensive project aimed at enhancing digital literacy and establishing a robust professional online presence. Through a series of structured tasks, I explored the creation of visual communication tools, the development of technical and professional portfolios on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, and the practical application of data science tools via Kaggle.

Additionally, the project addresses the critical importance of digital etiquette and cybercrime awareness. The findings demonstrate that a combination of technical proficiency, clear communication, and online safety is essential for success in the modern academic and professional landscape.

TASK 1: TO CREATE THIS INFOGRAPHIC

I used **Canva** (canva.com), a free browser-based design tool that offers ready-made templates, drag-and-drop elements, icons, and custom color palettes — making it accessible even without a graphic design background.

My design is a single-page visual resource divided into four color-coded sections covering: useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. A bold header defines what digital literacy means, and each section uses icons, pill-style labels, and short tips to keep information easy to scan. I chose a warm paper-toned background with teal, coral, blue, and purple accents so each topic feels distinct but visually connected.

One thing I found genuinely interesting was deciding *how much* information to include. Canva makes it tempting to keep adding elements, but I had to keep reminding myself that a good infographic communicates at a glance — not a scroll. Stripping content down to only what was essential, while still making it visually engaging, was the real design challenge.

TASK 2: BUILD YOUR STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

For my professional and academic journey, I have chosen two powerful platforms — **GitHub** and **LinkedIn** — each serving a distinct but complementary purpose.

GitHub is a cloud-based version control and collaboration platform used by developers worldwide to host, manage, and share code. It allows me to track changes in my projects, contribute to open-source work, and build a visible portfolio of my technical skills. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to document every significant project I work on, contribute to open-source repositories, and demonstrate consistent growth as a developer through my commit history.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform designed to connect individuals with employers, peers, and industry opportunities. It serves as a digital resume and networking hub. Over the next four years, I intend to build my professional profile by showcasing certifications, internships, and projects, connecting with industry professionals, and staying updated on trends in my field.

Together, these platforms will help me establish a strong digital presence — one that reflects both my technical abilities and professional character as I transition from student to industry professional.

TASK 3: DIGITAL SKILLS DEVELOPMENT – HACKERRANK CERTIFICATION PROJECT

For this project, I used **HackerRank**, an online competitive programming and skill assessment platform, to build and validate my foundational technical skills. I completed two certification tests: **Python (Basic)** and **Problem Solving (Basic)**, both earned on 4th November 2025, with certificate IDs C81233AFAF75 and 7A0242A11574 respectively.

Through Python (Basic), I practised core programming concepts including data types, control flow, functions, and basic data structures. The Problem Solving (Basic) certification involved practising algorithmic thinking, loops, conditionals, and logical reasoning through structured coding challenges.

Additionally, I created a **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** using **Google Forms**, a free cloud-based tool by Google. I designed questions covering topics such as phishing, online safety, password strength, and digital literacy concepts — reinforcing both my understanding and my ability to present information clearly.

These tools will help me academically by strengthening my logical thinking, improving my programming foundation, and familiarising me with widely-used digital tools — all essential skills for computer science coursework, internships, and real-world technical projects.

TASK 4: POOR DIGITAL COMMUNICATION: A REAL-WORLD CONSEQUENCE

In 2013, a US-based PR executive named Justine Sacco tweeted a racially insensitive joke to her 170 followers just before boarding a long-haul flight. By the time she landed, the tweet had gone viral globally, trending under the hashtag **#HasJustineLandedYet**. She was fired before she even stepped off the plane.

This case illustrates how a single moment of careless digital communication can cause irreversible professional and reputational damage. The post lacked empathy, cultural awareness, and basic judgment — all essential elements of responsible online behaviour.

What could have been done differently? Simply pausing before posting. Applying the **"think before you post"** principle — asking whether the content could offend, mislead, or misrepresent — would have prevented the situation entirely. Digital communication requires the same thoughtfulness as face-to-face interaction, if not more

TASK 5: PERSONAL REFLECTION: CYBERCRIME AWARENESS

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how **psychologically precise** UPI fraud is. The scam does not exploit a technical flaw — it exploits *human expectation*. A seller is already anticipating money, already excited, already trusting. The fraudster simply slides a collect request into that emotional window. The victim does not make a mistake out of ignorance; they make it out of context. That distinction is unsettling because it means awareness alone is not always enough — the attack is designed to work *around* awareness.

The statistic that also caught me off guard: cyber fraud calls to helpline **1930** crossed **1.2 lakh complaints per month** in 2023, the majority being payment fraud targeting ordinary people, not corporations.

One habit I will personally change: Before approving any UPI request, I will pause and ask one question — *"Did I initiate this?"* If the answer is no, I will reject it without exception, regardless of who claims to be sending it.

Case Study & Cybercrime Sources

Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India — Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C). National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal. Available at: https://cybercrime.gov.in

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) — Guidelines on Digital Payments Safety and UPI Fraud Awareness. Available at: https://www.rbi.org.in

CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) — Cybersecurity advisories and best practices. Available at: https://www.cert-in.org.in

Ronson, J. (2015). “How One Stupid Tweet Blew Up Justine Sacco’s Life.” The New York Times Magazine, 12 February 2015. Available at: https://www.nytimes.com

National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) — UPI Product Overview and Safety Guidelines. Available at: https://www.npci.org.in

CONCLUSION — OVERALL LEARNING FROM THE PROJECT

This project has been a comprehensive journey through digital literacy, covering five interconnected areas: visual communication, professional presence, technical skill-building, responsible digital behaviour, and cybersecurity awareness. Each task revealed how deeply technology shapes both opportunity and risk for college students today. Designing the infographic taught me that clarity matters more than quantity. Building GitHub and LinkedIn profiles showed me that a digital identity is built gradually, through consistent and intentional action. The HackerRank certifications reinforced that structured learning has measurable value. Analysing the Justine Sacco case made real the permanence of online actions. Most profoundly, researching UPI fraud exposed how social engineering exploits trust rather than ignorance — a reminder that awareness must be paired with habit. Taken together, these tasks have shifted my approach from passive internet use to active, informed, and responsible digital citizenship.

REFERENCES

Tools & Platforms Used

Canva (canva.com) — Infographic design tool. Available at: https://www.canva.com

HackerRank (hackerrank.com) — Python (Basic) Certificate ID: C81233AFAF75; Problem Solving (Basic) Certificate ID: 7A0242A11574. Available at: https://www.hackerrank.com

Google Forms (forms.google.com) — Used to create the Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. Available at: https://forms.google.com

GitHub (github.com) — Version control and portfolio platform. Available at: https://www.github.com

LinkedIn (linkedin.com) — Professional networking platform. Available at: https://www.linkedin.com